

JOB-READINESS WORKBOOK

A Comprehensive Guide for Young Adults with Autism

For Therapists, Teachers & Caregivers

Evolving Therapy & Wellness

Helping children grow into who they're meant to be

How to Use This Workbook

This interactive workbook is designed for professionals (occupational therapists, teachers, career counselors, or caregivers) working with young adults on the autism spectrum who are preparing for employment.

Structure of This Workbook:

- Section 1: Client Profile & Strengths Assessment
- Section 2: Job Exploration & Job Match Assessment
- Section 3: Job Search Strategy & Application Guide
- Section 4: Interview Preparation & Scripts
- Section 5: Sensory Considerations During Employment
- Section 6: Follow-Up & Job Coaching Resources

How to Implement:

- Work through sections sequentially with your client over 4-6 weeks
- Adapt language and depth based on your client's communication level
- Use as a printable resource or digital fillable document
- Facilitate discussion; record client's responses directly in the workbook
- Keep workbook as reference material throughout job search process

SECTION 1: Client Profile & Assessment

1.1 Client Information

Client Name:	
Date of Birth / Age:	
Facilitator Name:	
Date Started:	

1.2 Strengths & Abilities Inventory

Instructions: Check the boxes that describe your client's strengths. Be specific and observation-based.

Work-Related Strengths:

☐	Detail-oriented, notices small mistakes
☐	Follows rules and instructions carefully
☐	Organized and likes things in order
☐	Can focus on one task for a long time
☐	Works well independently, minimal supervision needed
☐	Good with technology or computers
☐	Reliable and shows up on time
☐	Asks for help when unclear about instructions
☐	Stays calm when things change unexpectedly
☐	Has a special interest they know a lot about

Additional Strengths (Describe):

Top 3 Strengths to Build On in Job Search:

1.

2.

3.

1.3 Interests & Preferences

What activities, topics, or work does your client enjoy or show interest in?

1.4 Sensory & Environmental Considerations

Identify key sensory needs or environmental preferences early:

Sensory Sensitivities:

Hearing sensitivity: _____

Visual sensitivity: _____

Touch/texture sensitivity: _____

Movement/balance concerns: _____

Preferred Work Environment:

- ☐ Quiet, minimal distractions
- ☐ Remote/work from home
- ☐ Independent work preferred
- ☐ Structured, predictable routine
- ☐ Needs frequent breaks
- ☐ Needs fidget/movement opportunities

SECTION 2: Job Exploration & Job Matching

2.1 Job Categories Overview

Review these job categories with your client. Identify 3-5 that align with their strengths and interests.

	Job Category	Examples
☐	Technology & Computer Work	Data entry, coding, IT support
☐	Detail & Organization	Filing, inventory, bookkeeping
☐	Structured Routine Work	Stocking, cleaning, warehouse
☐	Creative & Hands-On	Design, photography, crafts
☐	Retail/Specialty Store	Gaming store, pet store clerk
☐	Remote Work (Best Option)	Virtual assistant, content writing

2.2 Job Match Assessment

For the top 3 job categories selected above, rate the fit for your client:

Job Type	Good Fit?	Why/Why Not	Priority
	☐ Yes ☐ No		☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3
	☐ Yes ☐ No		☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3
	☐ Yes ☐ No		☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3

2.3 Job Search Parameters

Based on the assessment above, define parameters for the job search:

Preferred job type(s):

Must-have features (remote, quiet, independent work, etc.):

Nice-to-have features:

Avoid (what doesn't work for this client):

SECTION 3: Job Search Strategy & Application

3.1 Where to Search for Jobs

Key job search platforms:

Platform	Website	Best For
LinkedIn	linkedin.com	Most jobs, professional
Indeed	indeed.com	Large database, easy filters
Glassdoor	glassdoor.com	Jobs + company reviews
FlexJobs	flexjobs.com	Remote jobs only
Company Website	[company].com/careers	Direct applications

3.2 How to Read a Job Ad: Red Flags & Green Lights

Help your client evaluate whether a job ad is a good fit by looking for these clues:

GREEN LIGHTS (Signs the job might work):

- "Entry-level" or "no experience necessary"
- "Detail-oriented" or "organized people" wanted
- "Remote" or "work from home"
- "Independent work" or "minimal supervision"
- "Structured role" or "clear procedures"
- "Training provided"

RED FLAGS (Proceed with caution):

- "Fast-paced" or "high-pressure environment"
- "Must be outgoing/extroverted"
- "Multitasking" or "constant switching between tasks"
- Vague job description (unclear what they'll actually do)
- "5+ years experience required" for entry-level job
- Very low pay for full-time work

3.3 How to Find Jobs on a Company Website

Step-by-step guide to navigate company career pages:

1. Go to the company's main website
2. Look for link at bottom ("Careers," "Jobs," "Work With Us")
3. Or search for "[Company Name] careers" in Google
4. Click on the jobs/careers link
5. Use filters: location, job type, experience level
6. Click on job title to read full description
7. Look for "Apply" button to start application

3.4 Job Fit Evaluation Checklist

Before your client applies, use this checklist:

☐	I understand what the job actually is
☐	The job matches my client's interests
☐	My client has or can learn the skills needed
☐	Work environment is manageable (sensory-wise)
☐	Schedule works for my client
☐	Pay is fair/acceptable
☐	Location/accessibility is workable
☐	My client has 3+ of their strengths matching the job
☐	My client could see themselves in this role for 6+ months

Checked 7+ boxes: Recommend applying!

Checked 5-6 boxes: Discuss pros/cons before deciding

Checked less than 5: Keep looking for better fit

SECTION 4: Resume & Application

4.1 Simple Resume Template for Your Client

Use this template to help your client create a clean, straightforward resume:

[CLIENT NAME]

[Phone] | [Email] | [City, State]

Professional Summary

Seeking a [job type] position where I can use my skills in [2-3 skills] to contribute to a team. Detail-oriented and reliable professional.

Skills

- Detail-oriented and organized
- Reliable and dependable
- [Specific skill: computer skills, data entry, etc.]
- Quick learner who follows instructions

Experience

[Job Title] | [Company] | [Dates]

- What you did
- Specific achievement or task
- How you helped the team

Education

[School Name] | [Diploma Type] | [Year]

4.2 Facilitator Notes: Resume Building

- What to include:
 - Volunteer work (counts as experience)
 - School projects or clubs relevant to job
 - Certifications or training completed
 - Any tech skills or special abilities
- What to avoid:
 - Fancy graphics or colors (unless design field)
 - Long paragraphs (use bullet points)
 - Personal information (age, marital status, photo)
 - Mentioning autism (unless client chooses to disclose)

SECTION 5: Interview Preparation

5.1 What is an Interview?

An interview is a conversation where the employer learns about your client and your client learns about the job. Both sides are trying to figure out: "Is this a good match?"

5.2 Pre-Interview Checklist

☐	Know date, time, location (or Zoom link)
☐	Plan travel route and timing (arrive 15 min early)
☐	Choose appropriate clothing and lay it out
☐	Practice interview scripts/answers out loud
☐	Write down 2-3 questions to ask about the job
☐	Print/bring 2-3 copies of resume
☐	Get good sleep the night before
☐	Eat breakfast morning of interview
☐	Meet sensory needs before interview (exercise, stimming)

5.3 Interview Script Bank

Use these scripts to help your client prepare responses. Practice out loud multiple times.

Script 1: "Tell Me About Yourself"

This is often the opening question. Keep it to under 60 seconds.

My name is [Name]. I have [X years] of experience with [relevant skill], and I'm very [two strengths: organized/detail-oriented/reliable]. I'm interested in this [Job Title] position because [one reason]. I think my [strength] would help me succeed here.

Script 2: "What Are Your Strengths?"

My main strengths are being detail-oriented and organized. I notice small mistakes that others miss, and I like systems. I'm also reliable—if I say I'll do something, I do it.

Script 3: "What Are Your Weaknesses?" (Tricky!)

I can be quiet and reserved when I first start a new job, but I'm reliable and I show up ready to work. Once I understand the systems and processes, I'm very consistent.

Script 4: "Why Do You Want This Job?"

I'm very interested in [specific work type]. I like work that has clear processes and where I can focus on doing one thing well. This position seems like it would let me do that.

Script 5: "Do You Have Questions for Us?"

Always say YES and ask 2-3 questions:

- "Can you describe what a typical day looks like in this role?"
- "What kind of training or support would I receive when I start?"
- "When do you expect to make a decision?"

5.4 Sensory Accommodations for Interviews

Challenge	What to Do	Scripts/Language
Eye contact is hard	Look at nose/mouth or notes	Optional: "I focus better when I take notes"
Fidgeting needed	Stress ball under table, click pen, cross legs	No need to mention
Didn't understand question	Ask to repeat or ask for example	"Can you repeat that?" or "Can you give me an example?"
Overwhelmed/anxious	Breathe slowly, ask for water, pause before answering	"Could I get some water?" (buys time)

SECTION 6: After the Interview

6.1 Thank-You Email Template

Send within 24 hours:

Subject: Thank You - [Client Name], [Job Title] Interview
Dear [Their Name], Thank you for taking the time to interview me today for the [Job Title] position. I enjoyed learning about [specific thing from interview] and the opportunity to discuss how my [skill] could help your team. I'm very interested in this position and would love to work here. Best regards, [Client Name] [Phone] [Email]

6.2 Waiting for Response

Timeline:

- After 1 week: Okay to send short follow-up email
- After 2 weeks with no response: Likely hired someone else
- After 2 weeks: Move on and apply elsewhere

6.3 If They Say No

This is normal and not a reflection of your client's worth. Most people don't get every job they apply for.

- Send polite closing email
- Optionally ask for feedback (they may not respond)
- Keep applying to other jobs
- Don't take it personally
- Remember: Each "no" brings you closer to a "yes"

6.4 If They Say Yes!

Next steps:

- Thank them enthusiastically
- Confirm start date in writing (email)
- Ask what to bring on first day
- Ask about dress code
- Ask about arrival time/where to go
